As Rose sat down, the cardboard caved inward. A light breeze drifted in through the dormer window, but the roof extended wide over the building, blocking the sun so it appeared to be dusk though it was morning. “Léa was caught smuggling wine and sent to an internment camp.”

“Mon Dieu. Where?” His face was pinched.

“In Jargeau.”

“When?”

“Last night.” Rose should have insisted that Léa run back with her to the tunnel. They could have escaped together, but she’d only thought of herself, leaving Léa alone to face the consequences. She explained how they’d been kicked out of the boardinghouse, had gone to live with the LeBlanc family and, after Monsieur LeBlanc was arrested, smuggled wine for him, and that he’d been executed because of his Resistance work. Desperation rang in her voice as she told him everything, hoping there was a way to save Léa. “Is it possible to get her out?”

“Everything is possible in Occupied France,” he said.

That was when he told her about the pressure the Vichy government was under to supply more workers to Germany for the war effort. Rose had seen the posters everywhere, initially encouraging people to sign up to work, then later, announcing that it was mandatory for certain age groups. And André had been sent. She leaned forward, listening intently.

“They go to the camps and prisons recruiting, promising to pay salaries and clear criminal records in return for working in Germany.”

“Including women?” Rose was sure that Léa would never do anything to help the Germans win the war.

“Even if our leaders put us on the German side.” He sighed. “I don’t want to misrepresent what working in Germany would be like. It’s an option but also a gamble.”

As Rose listened, she traced a finger along the box’s edge, trying to line up in her mind all that he was saying.

“There’s no guarantee where she’ll be sent—a munitions factory in Berlin, a farm in Saxony, a bakery in Hamburg.” He rubbed his chin. “If I had some influence or leverage, I could try to persuade the officials at the German Employment Office in Orléans to give her office work away from a city, explain that she’d been an exceptional employee and is an excellent typist.” He took a breath. “But I don’t have anything to offer them in return